PROJECT IDENTITY AND CONCEPT

General Overview

Name of the Game: Zavod (working title)
Team: DJ-252 - Baciu Irina, Colesnicenco Ecaterina, Priseajniuc Ecaterina, Vasilciuc Lia
Genre: Gambling
Game Elements: Gacha Collection, Resource Management, Branching Dialogues, Endings
Player: Single-player

Technical Specs

Technical Form: 2D, Pixel Graphics
View: 2D side perspective
Platform: PC Windows
Engine: GameMaker
Development Tools: Adobe Photoshop, Clip Studio Paint, ibisPaint, Aseprite, FL Studio
Language: GML
Device: PC

Current Design Snapshot

In One Sentence: The player manages a factory worker's Money, Health, and Mental Stability while taking risky side jobs and using a Gacha Machine to obtain a desired legendary figurine of a femboy in fourteen days.

Current Stage: Concept and early prototype. Most of the artwork, script and music are done; core gameplay systems are confirmed. Coding and playtest are the main next steps.

PLAYER FANTASY AND EXPERIENCE

Who is the Player?

  (Sprites of the main character).

The player is a factory worker whose only source of joy is collecting figures from a Gacha Machine. His salary is not enough to guarantee the desired legendary figure. The goal is to obtain the legendary figure in fourteen in-game days.

What are They Trying to Achieve?

Obtain one specific legendary figure before the end of Day 14. The player must also keep Health Points and Mental Stability Points above zero. If either reaches zero, then the game ends. As well, the player needs to avoid bad endings from NPCs.

What do They Mainly do?

Explore the street, talk to up to two NPCs per day, accept or refuse jobs, earn currency, buy food to restore Health Points, and spend currency on gacha pulls to restore Mental Stability Points and progress toward the legendary figure.

What Makes It Unique?

The game forces a direct conflict between basic human needs and gacha addiction. Maintaining both costs the same currency. Food preserves Health Points, while pulls restore Mental Stability Points and advance the collection. The player cannot fully satisfy both. The fourteen-day limit makes every wasted day costly.

Design Pillars

Pillar	What it means	What we avoid
Risk versus reward	High-paying jobs can damage Health or Mental Stability, or trigger a special ending.	Rewards that are always positive or risk-free.
Resource pressure	Money must be divided between food and gacha pulls while the day counter advances.	A money system with no meaningful trade-offs.
Player choice and dark comedy	NPC dialogue lets the player refuse tasks and choose between ordinary, strange, and uncomfortable offers.	Forcing every task or relying on story text without consequences.

Desired Player Experience

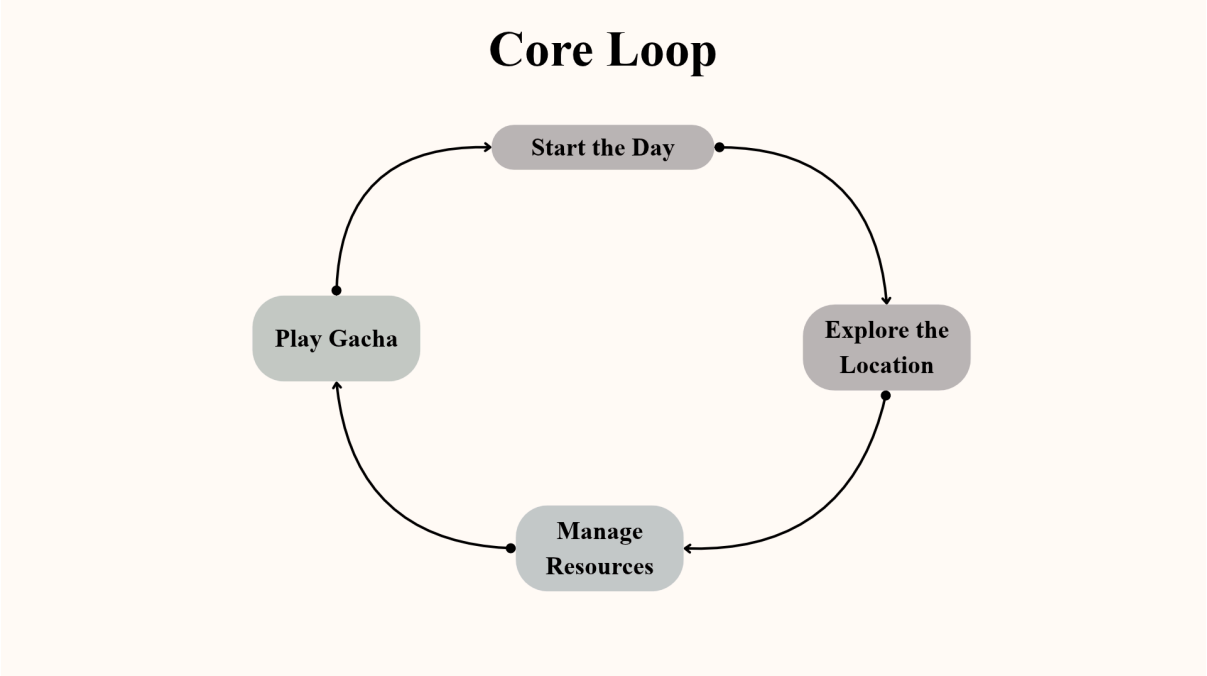
The player should pause before accepting a suspicious job, compare the reward with the possible loss, and explain why they chose food, a gacha pull, or another day of work. The intended feeling is anxious curiosity mixed with dark humour.

Audience and Session Length

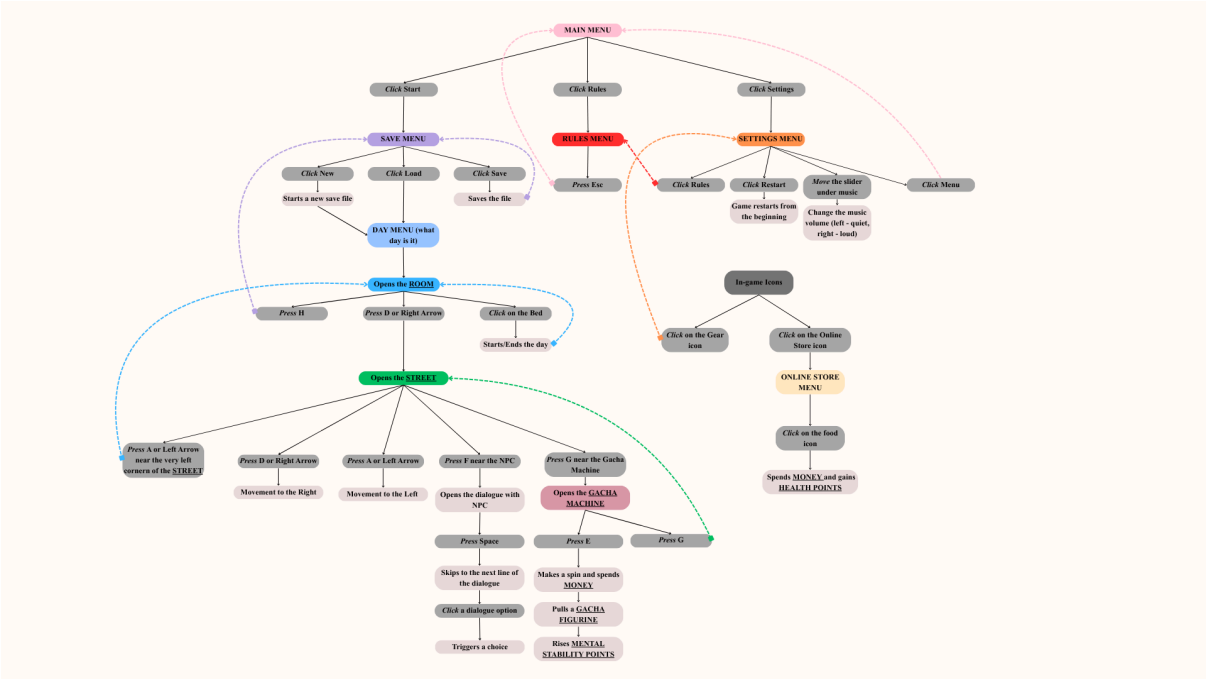
The target audience is players aged 14 and older who enjoy short narrative games, resource management, and comedy. The game is single-player. A full run lasts fourteen in-game days. Session length has not been measured yet, but the design targets a short, repeatable experience 15-25 minutes per run.

CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

The simplified core loop of the very main points of the game.



Feedback Loop



The Loop

Step	Action	Consequence	Feedback
1. The Room	Start a new day. Apply daily factory losses.	Health Points and Mental Stability Points decrease.	Black screen with day number. Bars update.
2. The Street	Explore the Street. Meet up to two NPCs.	The player chooses which NPCs to approach.	Interaction prompts appear.
3. Dialogue	Talk to NPCs. Accept or refuse jobs.	Currency, Health Points, or Mental Stability Points changes.	Dialogue box and resource change indicators.
4. The Gacha Machine	Buy food and use the Gacha Machine.	Food restores Health Points. Pulls cost 20 currency, restore 3 Mental Stability Points, and add a figure to the collection.	Price shown before purchase. Gacha reveals animation.
5. Review	Check resources, collection, and pull count.	The player reviews the current state.	HUD shows all values.
6. Repeat	End the day. Advance to the next day.	If Day 14 ends without the target, the run ends.	Confirmation screen.

Exit Conditions

The loop ends when the player obtains the desired legendary figure, reaches zero Health Points or Mental Stability Points, triggers a special ending, or reaches the end of Day 14 without the target figure.

MECHANICS AND MEANINGFUL DECISIONS

Controls (Planned)

Action	Input
Move left	A or left arrow
Move right	D or right arrow
Enter/Leave Gacha Machine area	G
Talk to NPC	F
Advance dialogue	Space
Open save menu	H (in the Room)
Open pause menu	Esc
Use Gacha Machine	E

The camera follows the hero on the Street. The Room and gacha area have fixed cameras.

Save and Load (Planned)

Property	Rule
Location	Save in the Room by pressing H.
Slots	One slot. New save overwrites previous.
Start/Restart menu	Option to start a new game or load the last save.
Status	Planned, not implemented.

Health Points (HP)

Property	Rule
Starting value	70
Maximum	100
Daily loss	10 at the start of each day (from Day 2 onward)
Recovery	Food
Failure	If Health Points reach 0, the Lost Health ending triggers.

Health is displayed as a stomach-shaped bar. The image changes as the value drops.

Mental Stability Points (MSP)

Property	Rule
Starting value	80
Maximum	100
Daily loss	5 at the start of each day. If MSP is below 50, the daily loss becomes 10.
Recovery	Each gacha pull restores 3 MSP.
Failure	If MSP reaches 0, the Lost Mental Stability ending triggers.

Mental Stability Points are displayed as a brain-shaped bar. The image changes as the value drops.

Currency (Bucks)

Property	Rule
Starting value	550 (monthly salary)
Day 1 deduction	40 for services. Remaining balance: 510.
Income	NPC jobs
Spending	Food (2 to 10 per item), gacha pulls (20 each)
Insufficient funds	A dialogue box explains that the player does not have enough money. The purchase does not occur.

Online Shop

Food	Cost	Health Points restored
Chicken leg	2	+3
Chicken cutlet	4	+6
Omelette	10	+10

Limit: The player can buy a maximum of 3 food items per day, total. This resets each day.

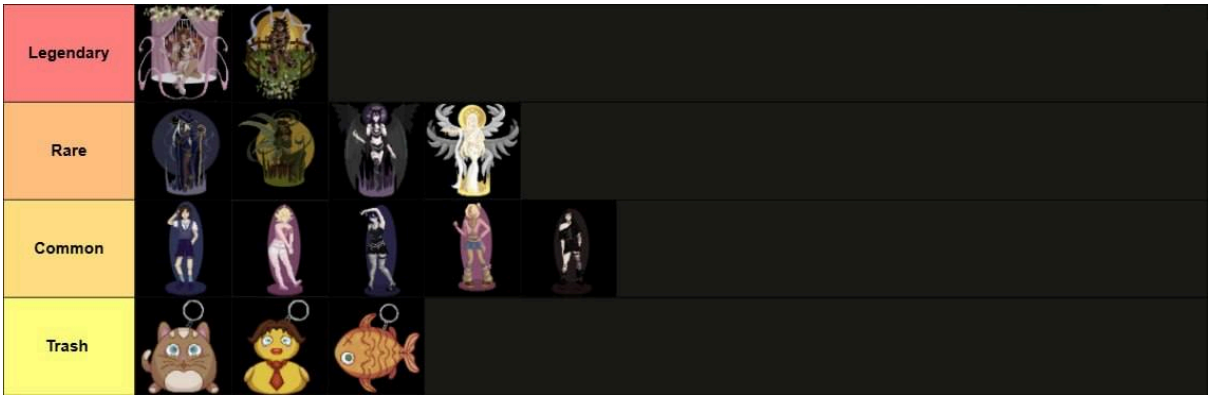
The Gacha Machine

Property	Rule
Location	Gacha Machine area (press G from the Street to enter, press G again to leave)
Cost per pull	20 currency
MSP restored per pull	+3
Total items	14 (3 Trash, 5 Common, 4 Rare, 2 Legendary)
Pity system	Pull 30 is a guaranteed Legendary.
Reset	Getting any Legendary resets the pity counter.

Base Probabilities of the Figurines

Rarity	Total chance	Items	Chance per item
Trash	46%	3	15.3333%
Common	33%	5	6.6%
Rare	20%	4	5%
Legendary	1%	2	0.5%

Total: 46%+33%+20%+1%=100% - Total chance; 3+5+4+2=14 - Items



As Legendary chance increases, Trash chance decreases to keep the total at 100%. Common stays at 33%, Rare at 20%, but on the pull 30 they are reduced to 0%. The player can still receive the wrong Legendary figure on pull 30, which triggers the Pulled the Wrong One ending.

Legendary Chance Progression

Pulls	Legendary chance
1 to 20	1% each
21	1.2%
22	1.4%
23	1.6%
24	1.8%
25	2%
26	3%
27	4%
28	6%
29	10%
30	100% guaranteed

Trash Chance Progression

Pulls	Trash chance
1 to 20	46% each
21	45.8%
22	45.6%
23	45.4%
24	45.2%
25	45%
26	44%
27	43%
28	41%
29	37%
30	0%

NPC Dialogue and Jobs

The player can interact with up to two NPCs per day. Some NPCs appear only after previous tasks are completed. Each NPC has a fixed schedule. If the condition is not met, the NPC does not appear.

Full NPC List (Planned)

NPC	Task	Reward	Cost	Limit	Notes
Janitor	Substitute for his shift	+10 currency	-2 HP, -3 MSP	2 times	If insulted, no reward. Dialogue changes.
Old woman	Carry groceries	+5 currency	-2 MSP	5 times	If insulted, the Cooked into Soup ending triggers.
Child	Push on swing and eat what he offers	+3 to +10 currency (random)	-7 HP, -7 MSP	3 times	
Pervert 1	Sell current underwear	+40 currency	-10 MSP	2 times	Opens Pervert 2.
Pervert 2	Photo in provided underwear	+60 currency, +10 MSP	No stat cost	1 time	Requires Pervert 1 twice.
Pervert 3	Appear in a video in gifted underwear	+100 currency, +20 MSP	No stat cost	1 time	Requires Pervert 1 and 2.
Shopkeeper	Compliment her in dialogue	+6 currency	-2 MSP	6 times	
Tycoon	Accept his offer	+200 currency	-50 HP, -60 MSP	1 time	If both stats stay above 0, the player escapes a bad ending. If either

					reaches 0, badending triggers.
Surprise girl	Accept a date	+30 MSP	Costs 50 currency	2 times	
Rich schoolboy	Dance with underwear on head	+5 to +20 currency (random)	-5 HP, -8 MSP	1 time	
Drug dealer	Hide a stash	+100 currency	Prison ending	1 time	Irreversible.
Virtuous stranger	Choose appropriate responses	+40 currency, +20 MSP	No stat cost	3 times	

NPC Schedule (14 Days)

Day	NPC 1	NPC 2
1	Janitor (+10)	Old woman (+5)
2	Shopkeeper (+6)	Rich schoolboy (+5 to 20)
3	Old woman (+5)	Child (+3 to 10)
4	Shopkeeper (+6)	Old woman (+5)
5	Virtuous stranger (+40, +20 MSP)	Shopkeeper (+6)
6	Shopkeeper (+6)	Child (+3 to 10)
7	Pervert 1 (+40)	Drug dealer (+100, prison)
8	Surprise girl (-50)	Shopkeeper (+6)
9	Virtuous stranger (+40, +20 MSP)	Pervert 1 (+40)
10	Shopkeeper (+6)	Janitor (+10)
11	Old woman (+5)	Pervert 2 (+60, +10 MSP)
12	Child (+3 to 10)	Tycoon (+200, bad ending risk)
13	Surprise girl (-50)	Pervert 3 (+100, +20 MSP)
14	Old woman (+5)	Virtuous stranger (+40, +20 MSP)

Meaningful choice example:

The player meets the Tycoon on Day 12. Accepting his offer grants +200 currency but costs -50 Health Points and -60 Mental Stability Points. If either stat reaches zero, the bad ending triggers. If both stay above zero, the player escapes the bad ending and continues. Refusing the offer leaves the player with no reward but no penalty. The player must decide whether the 200 currency is worth the risk of a bad ending.

Meaningful Choice: Food versus Gacha

The core trade-off is explained in the economy. If the player spends all money on gacha pulls on Day 1, MSP reaches 100 and stops increasing. The player can make only 20 pulls from salary, but needs 30 for the guaranteed Legendary. The remaining 13 days become a survival struggle with no money for food. This likely leads to a Lost Health or Lost Mental Stability ending.

The most logical strategy is to buy three chicken legs every day (6 currency per day, 84 currency over 14 days). Remaining salary: 426 currency. This allows 21 pulls. The remaining 9 pulls (174 currency) must be earned from NPC jobs. Following this strategy guarantees access to the 30th pull, but the result is still 50/50 for the correct Legendary.

Edge Cases

Situation	Resolution
Health Points and Mental Stability Points both reach 0 on the same day	Health failure takes priority. Lost Health ending plays first.
Player hasn’t achieved the wanted Legendary on Day 14	Run ends with the Deadline ending unless a special ending is already triggered.
Player reaches 0 Health Points after accepting a job	Job reward is granted first, then the ending triggers.
Player reaches the 30th pull with both Legendaries available	One is awarded at random. Result determines Goal Achieved or Pulled the Wrong One.
Player tries to interact with a third NPC	NPC displays a refusal line. Interaction does not start.
Player insults the old woman	Cooked into Soup ending triggers immediately.
Player accepts the drug dealer's job	Prison ending triggers immediately.
Player accepts the Tycoon's offer and both stats stay above 0	The player escapes slavery and continues.
Player accepts the Tycoon's offer and either stat reaches 0	Bad ending triggers.

PROGRESSION, CONTENT, AND GAME STRUCTURE

How the Game Changes Over Time

Stage	What changes	Effect on player decisions
Days 1 to 3	The player learns daily losses, NPC limit, food prices, and pull cost.	Early choices establish priorities.

Days 4 to 9	Time shrinks. MSP may fall below 50, adding extra daily loss. Pity chance rises.	The player weighs survival against the increasing value of another pull.
Days 10 to 14	Deadline approaches. Legendary chance increases. Pull 30 guarantees a Legendary.	The player must judge whether another pull is affordable and which outcome is acceptable.

Minimum Playable Scope

The minimum playable version includes:

- One full 14-day run.
- Three playable locations: Room, Street, and Gacha Machine area.
- One non-playable location: main menu.
- 12 NPCs with dialogues, jobs, and consequences.
- 14 collectible figures.
- 3 food items.
- 4 soundtracks (one for each location).
- Dialogue system, save system, and 8 endings.
- Main menu, shop, and settings.

Stretch Ideas

- Achievements for unlocking endings.
- More figures and more days.
- Random NPC appearance instead of fixed schedule.
- Additional story branches.
- Location animations.
- Character’s idle animations.

Endings (8 Total)

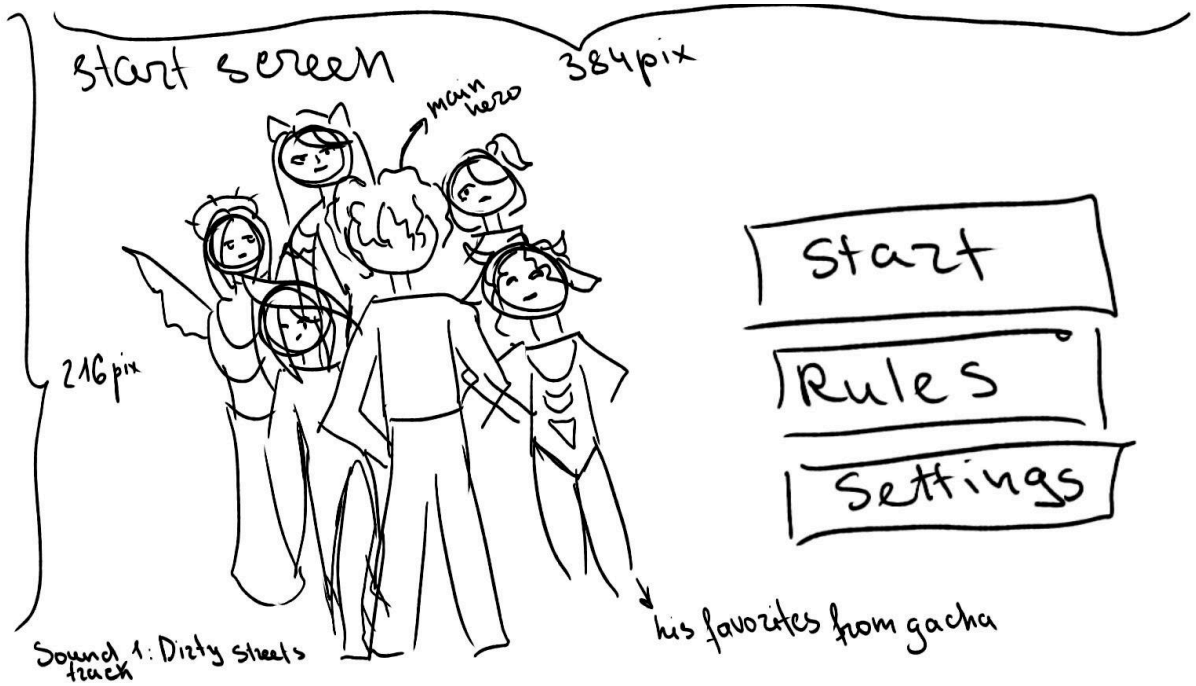
Ending	Trigger
Goal Achieved	The player obtains the desired Legendary figure.
Pulled the Wrong One	The player obtains the other Legendary figure.
Deadline Reached	The player does not obtain a Legendary by the end of Day 14.
Lost Health	Health Points reach 0.
Lost Mental Stability	Mental Stability Points reach 0.
Cooked into Soup	The player insults the old woman.
Life in Prison	The player accepts the drug dealer's job.
Bad Ending	The player accepts the Tycoon's offer and either Health Points or Mental Stability Points reach 0.

Collection System

Collected figures appear on a shelf in the hero's Room in reduced size. Duplicate pulls do not add a second copy to the shelf. There are 14 unique items to collect. The Room is intended to brighten as the collection grows, but exact brightness thresholds are not yet defined.

WORLD, NARRATIVE, AND PRESENTATION

Sketch of the Main Menu



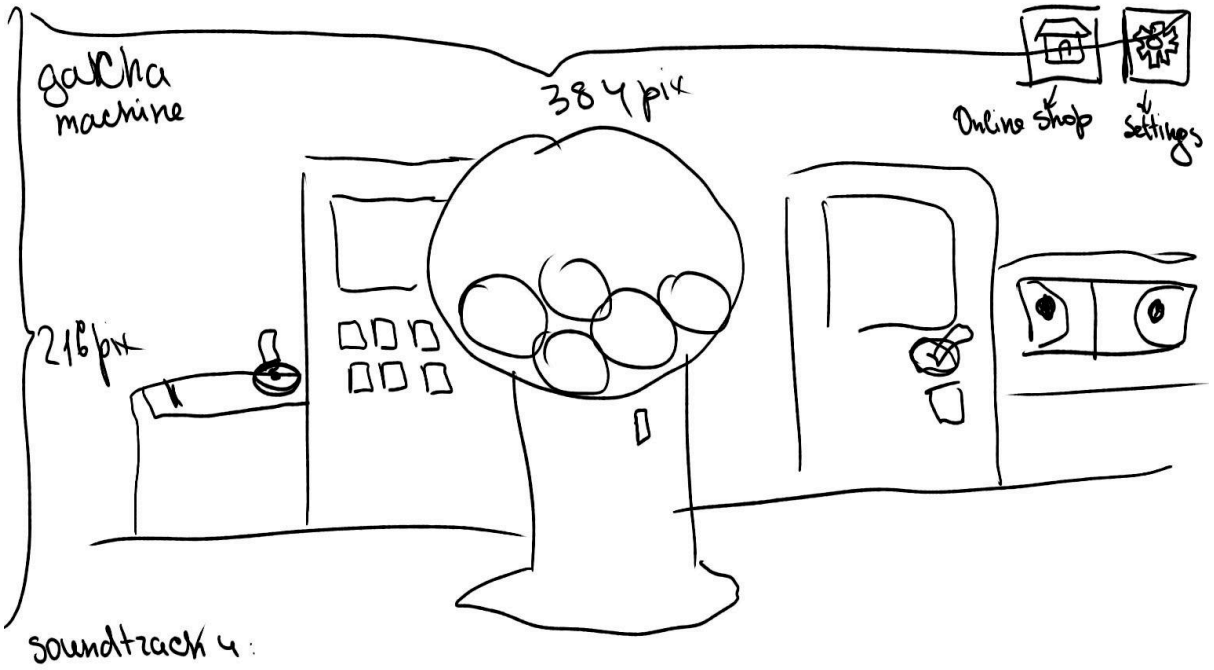
Sketch of the Room



Sketch of the Street



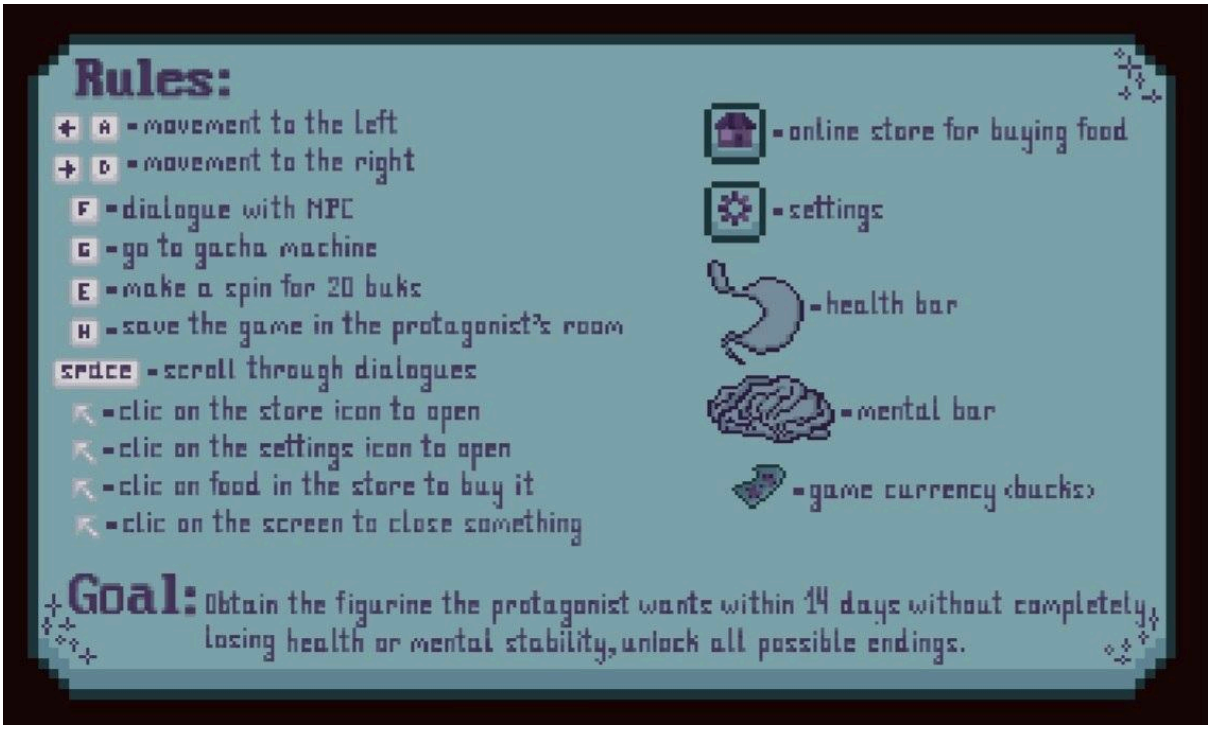
Sketch of the Gacha Machine



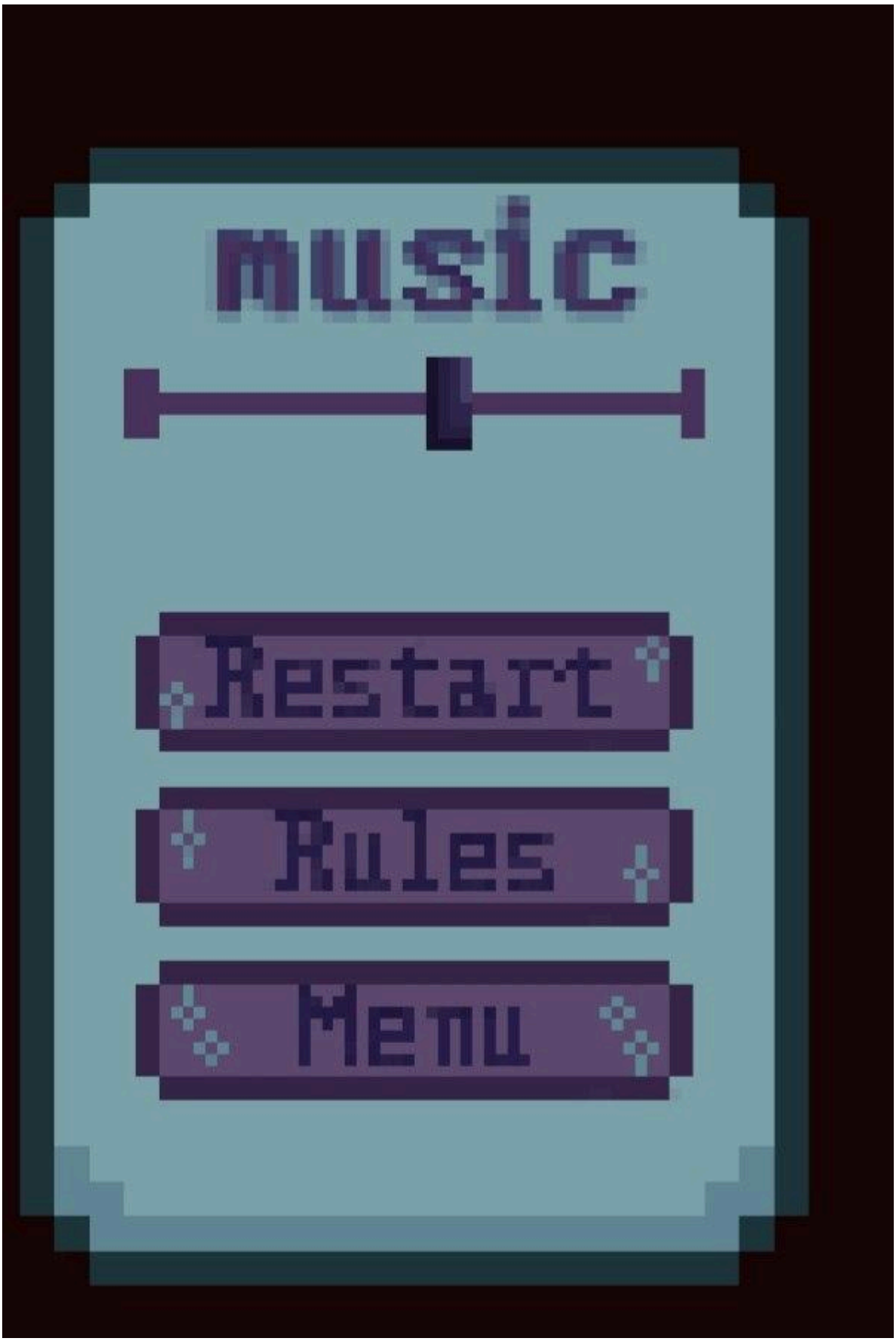
Sketch of the Gacha Pull



Concept Rules Menu



Concept Setting Menu


music
Restart
Rules
Menu

Concept Online Store



Concept Room



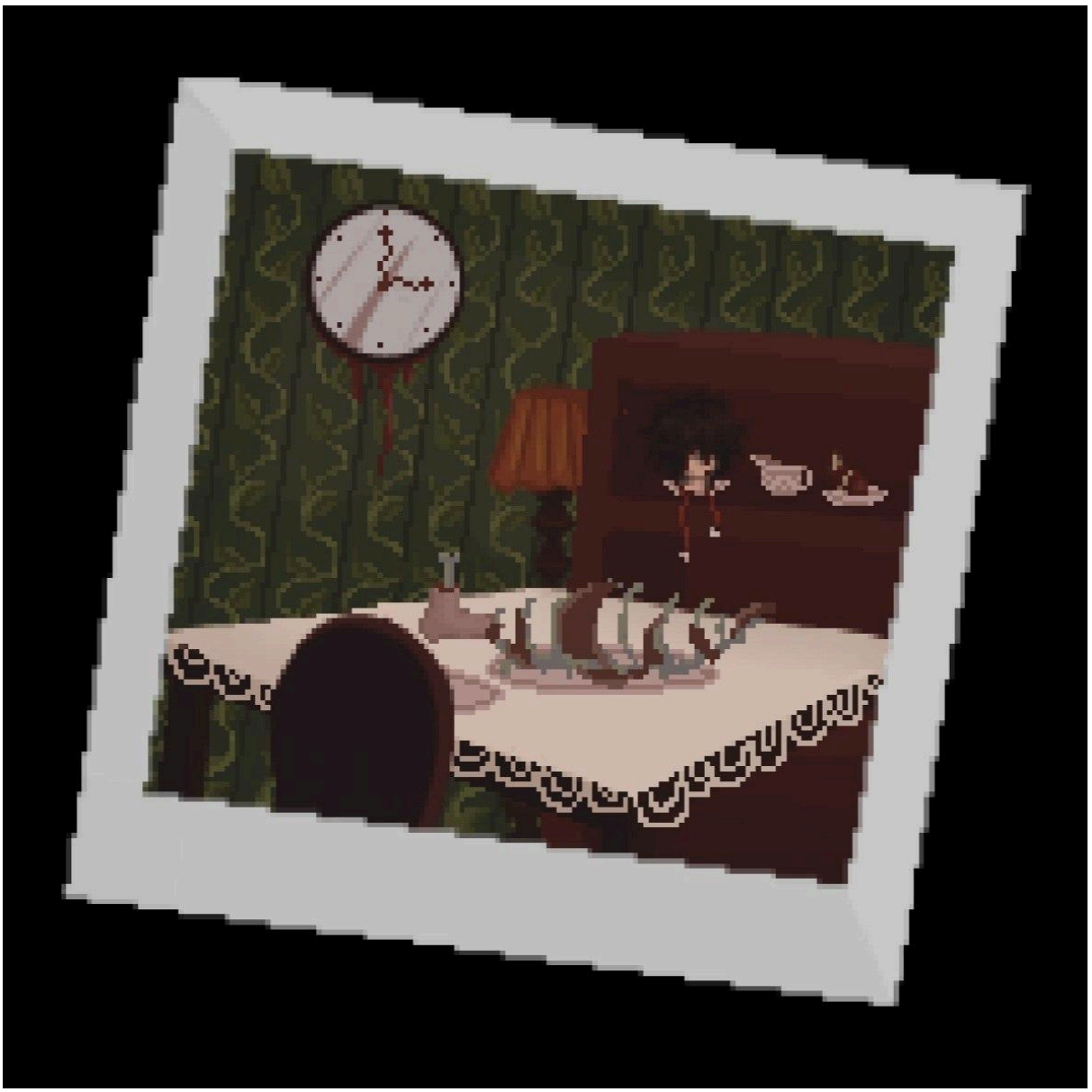
Concept Street



Concept Gacha Machine



Concept Bad Ending



Setting and Locations

Location	Purpose and atmosphere	Status
Room	Starting area, save point, and collection display. Intended to brighten as figures are collected.	Art exists. Progression thresholds to be defined.
Street	Main exploration area. NPCs, food shop, and Gacha Machine entrance. Gloomy atmosphere.	Location and NPC concepts exist. Implementation in progress.
Gacha Machine	Dedicated area for pulling figures.	The concept exists. Implementation in progress.
Factory	Narrative context only. Explains daily HP and MSP losses. Not playable. Represented by morning summary.	Not playable.

Narrative Presentation

Dialogue is presented in text boxes. An off-screen voice helps and sometimes taunts the hero. NPC choices affect rewards, resource changes, and endings. The tone combines mundane working life, absurd side jobs, and dark comedy. The game has no day/night cycle.

Visual Direction

The game uses pixel art and a 2D side view. The Room starts dim and becomes brighter as the collection grows. The Street is gloomier and serves as the main area for NPC interactions, the food shop, and the Gacha Machine. The visual contrast between the dull Room and the bright collection shelf shows progress.

References:

Papers Please (Lucas Pope, 2013). Muted pixel palette, mundane work contrasted with moral pressure, dark humour.

Interface Design

The HUD is always visible. It shows:

- Health bar (stomach icon).
- Mental Stability bar (brain icon).
- Current currency.
- Current day (Day X of 14).

Dialogue boxes show the NPC name, the task description, the reward, the cost, and the selectable responses. The selected response is visually distinct. The shop shows the price and the HP restored before purchase. The gacha screen shows the rarity in words, the figure, the pull count, and the MSP restored.

Audio Direction

Music exists and was created by the team. There are 4 soundtracks planned, one for each location. Music changes when the player moves to a new location. Sound effects are planned for footsteps, dialogue, purchases, gacha pulls, and endings. Volume control is available in the settings menu.

Asset Status

All art and music used in the game were created by the team. No AI. No third-party assets are used.

FEASIBILITY AND DEVELOPMENT DIRECTION

Engine/Tools:

Engine - GameMaker
Language - GML
Art tools - Adobe Photoshop, Clip Studio Paint, ibisPaint, Aseprite
Audio tools - FL Studio
Platform - Windows PC

Team

ID	Name	Role	Responsibilities	Skills
1	Baciu Irina	Game Designer, Narrative Designer.	Managing workflow, writing game design documents, writing the dialogues, creating a page on itch.io and github.	Proficiency in English, scriptwriting skills.
2	Colesnicenco Ecaterina	Team Leader, Programmer, Sound Designer, Artist (UI designer, figurines designer).	Monitoring deadlines, supervising the work of other team members, coding the game, composing the music, drawing the figurines, drawing the endings.	Team leadership experience, programming knowledge, composition experience, proficiency in digital art software.
3	Priseajniuc Ecaterina	Artist (background design, NPCs design).	Drawing the background, drawing NPCs.	Proficiency in digital art software.
4	Vasilciuc Lia	Artist (background design, main character design), Animator.	Drawing the background, drawing, the main character, animating the main character.	Proficiency in digital art software and animation.

Biggest Technical/Design Uncertainty

Can the pity system be implemented cleanly in GML without floating-point errors? The team must verify that every pull totals 100% and that the guaranteed pull on 30 works correctly.

Can the 14-day economy be balanced so that the player can reach the 30th pull without making the game too easy or too difficult? The team must simulate the full 14-day run with different strategies.

Next Step and Prototype Plan

The next step is to build a minimal playable prototype.

Item	Description
Design question	Does the core loop create meaningful tension in 3 in-game days?
Format	Playable PC build in GameMaker.
Included	Movement, 1 NPC, food shop, Gacha Machine, 3-day timer, 1 ending.
Simulated	14-day deadline via a shortened 3-day timer.
Omitted	Save system, remaining NPCs, remaining endings, Room brightness progression.

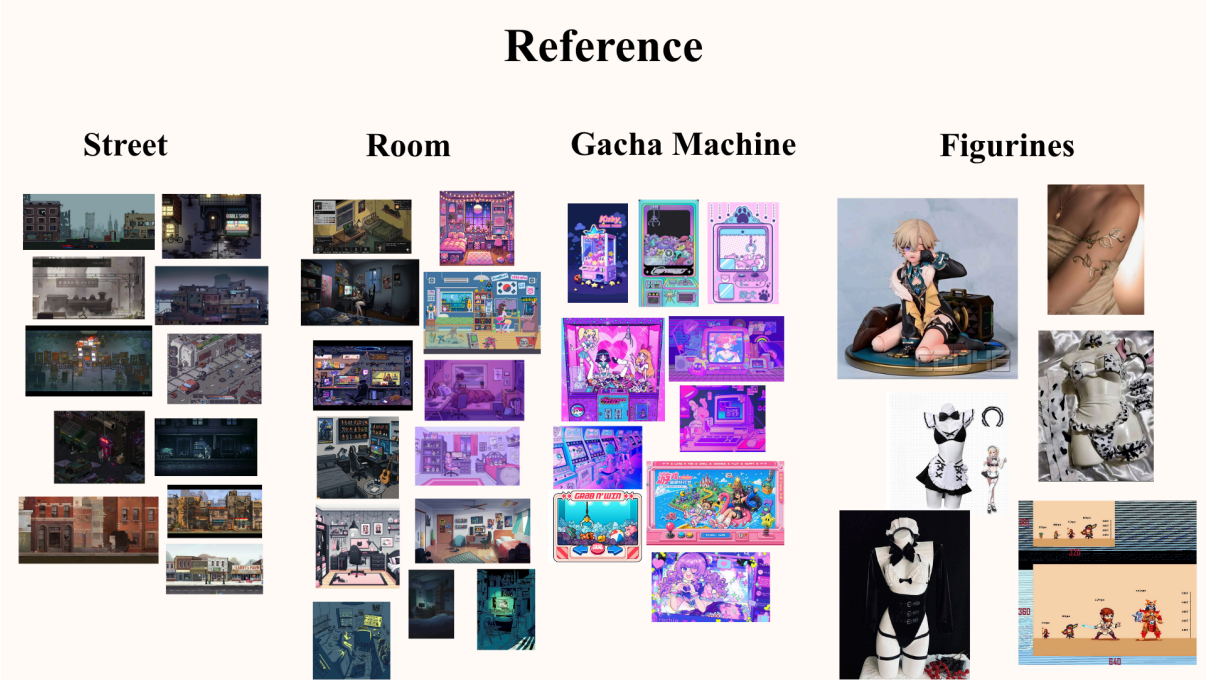
Completion Criteria for the Prototype

Item	Owner	Check	Target date	Fallback
Core loop playable	Team	3-day run completable	30.10.2026	Cut to 1 NPC
Gacha pity verified	Team	Probabilities total 100%	30.10.2026	Manual table
Dialogue system working	Team	1 NPC with 2 choices	27.10.2026	Hard-coded lines
Prototype test	Team	4 testers	30.10.2026	1 tester

Limitations

- No save system yet (planned).
- No day/night cycle.
- Some NPC names and prerequisites are undefined.
- No real playtesting has occurred yet.

REFERENCES



Sources

ID	Source	Link	Use
1	Steam, Papers Please	https://store.steampowered.com/app/239030/Papers_Please/	Reference for the overall vibe of the game.
2	Project itch.io page	https://ira-baciu.itch.io/zavod	Project page: arts, sketches, music.
3	Project GitHub repository	https://github.com/ira-baciu/Zavod	Assets and source files.
4	Canva	https://canva.link/m87j2me4vvhrix7	Core Loop.
5	Canva	https://canva.link/u2k58v5k7jj5wrx	Feedback Loop.
6	Canva	https://canva.link/sw2h0nkq01pbp6j	Inspiration.
7	TierMaker	https://tiermaker.com/create/zavod-19903204	Rarity of the figurines.

OTHER

Budget

SALARIES	
Baciu Irina	666$/month x 6 month=3996$
Colesnicenco Ecaterina	670$/month x 6 month=4020$
Priseajniuc Ecaterina	669$/month x 6 month=4014$
Vasilciuc Lia	669$/month x 6 month=4014$
SOFTWARE LICENCES	
Adobe Photoshop	22.99$/month x 6 month=137.94$
Clip Studio Paint	4.99$/month x 6 month=29.94$
Ibis Paint X Premium	2.99$/month x 6 month=17.94$
Aseprite	19.99$ - one time purchase
FL Studio	99$ - one time purchase
MARKETING	
Ads for promoting	50$/month x 3 month=150$
TOTAL	
salaries 16044$ + software 304.81$ + marketing 150$=**16498.81$**	

Figurines femboys art:

Trash Figurines







Common Figurines







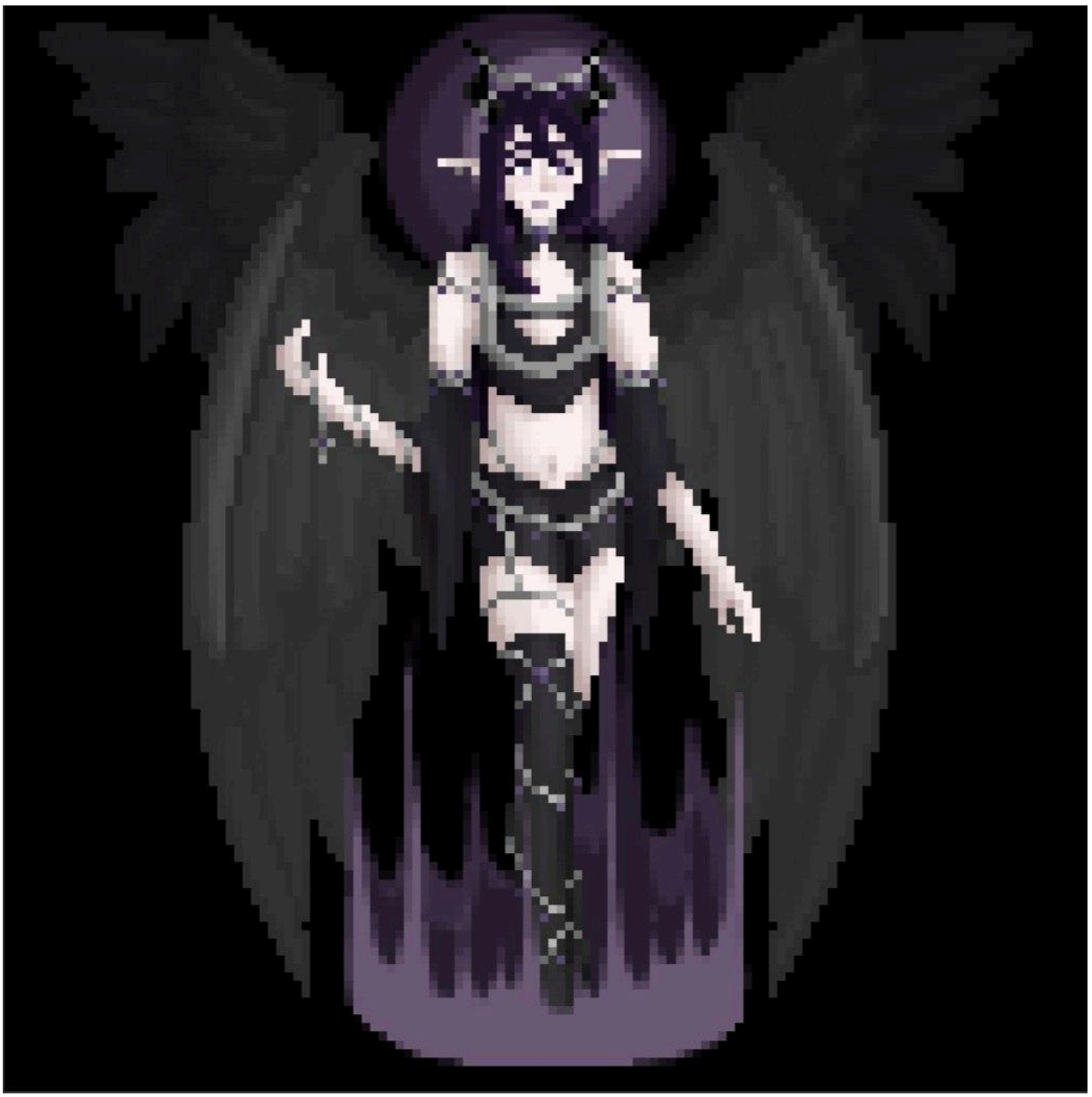




Rare Figurines









Legendary Figurines

